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■ US President Donald Trump holds the charter during a signing ceremony on his Board of Peace initiative at the Annual Meeting of the World Economic Forum in Davos yesterday.

AI tsunami could disrupt 40% of jobs worldwide, IMF chief warns

Georgieva's forecast came during a high-level dialogue hosted by the UAE at WEF

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Artificial intelligence is set to disrupt a significant share of the global workforce, the head of the International Monetary Fund warned in Davos.

Speaking at a high-level dialogue hosted by the UAE at the World Economic Forum, IMF Managing Director Kristalina Georgieva said the pace of technological change now confronting labour markets is without precedent.

AI is quickly reshaping economies. Some roles grow; others disappear. We must invest in skills and prepare communities.

Kristalina Georgieva
IMF Managing Director

IMF research suggests that about 40 per cent of global jobs will be affected by artificial intelligence, whether through enhancement, transformation or displacement. The risk, Georgieva said, lies not only in job losses but in uneven access to new opportunities. "A tsunami is hitting the labour market," Georgieva said. "AI is quickly

reshaping economies. Some roles grow; others disappear. We must invest in skills and prepare communities."

She warned that countries and regions moving faster on education, infrastructure and AI readiness will benefit disproportionately, widening gaps with those that lag behind.

"The world as a whole is already experiencing the arrival of AI, but I do worry about the accordion of opportunities that are much more present in some places than in others," she said.

Badr Jafar, the UAE's Special Envoy for Business and Philanthropy, said, "At a time when global systems are fragmenting, the UAE is doubling down on connection. We are known for open skies, open ports, and open minds."

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New District IO to add Dh103b to Dubai's GDP

DUBAI SILICON OASIS PROJECT TO BACK 6,500 FIRMS, 75,000 PROFESSIONALS

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday unveiled District IO at Dubai Silicon Oasis, a new economic project aimed at building a technology-driven business district expected to contribute more than Dh103 billion to Dubai's GDP over the next ten years.

In a post on X, Sheikh Mohammed said the project is designed to create an advanced business environment for emerging sectors, supporting more than 6,500 companies and 75,000 specialised professionals.

The launch formed part of a broader expansion of Dubai Silicon Oasis, with total investments of Dh12.8 billion, reinforcing its role within Dubai's knowledge and innovation economy. Sheikh Mohammed said the expansion reflects Dubai's strategy of adopting advanced technologies to serve society and the economy, while strengthening its position as a global destination for talent, investment, and future industries.

Major step

Sheikh Ahmed Bin Saeed Al Maktoum, Chairman of the Dubai Integrated Economic Zones Authority (DIEZ), said the expansion projects mark a major step in strengthening Dubai's position

70,000

direct and indirect jobs expected to be created over 10 years

as a hub for innovation, advanced technology, and the future economy, aligned with the Dubai Economic Agenda D33 and the Dubai 2040 Urban Master Plan.

District IO represents the largest component of the expansion, with investments of Dh11 billion. The development will span more than 300,000 square metres and comprise 25 LEED-certified buildings, including commercial, residential, and hospitality facilities. The project is expected to create more than 70,000 direct and indirect jobs over 10 years and attract up to Dh30 billion in foreign direct investment.

District IO will focus on six core sectors: artificial intelligence and quantum computing, robotics, smart mobility, 3D printing, Web3 technologies, and advanced "X-tech" industries. The first development phase begins in 2026 with offices, laboratories, and retail spaces, followed by hospitality and innovation facilities from 2027. The wider expansion also includes Block 14, a Dh1.8 billion residential and lifestyle district near the future Dubai Metro Blue Line, scheduled for completion in 2029.

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